Teacher and cover plan — Planning a gallery or exhibition inquiry

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 5 Part 1 · Big question: How do we design a structured visual inquiry plan to analyse artworks in an exhibition space?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Construct a four-lens Gallery inquiry Framework (Spatial context, Material execution, Tonal/Colour mechanics, and Critical impact).

• Prepare a field-sketching layout sheet with dedicated zones for thumbnail elevations, sightline maps, and detail transcriptions.

• Formulate three focused critical inquiry questions to test during next week's exhibition study.

Studio kit: A3 Gallery inquiry templates, curated exhibition pack previews, 2B/4B graphite, fineliners, viewfinders, clipboards

Arrival and starter

Arrival: When an art critic or advanced student enters an exhibition, why do they bring a prepared visual inquiry sheet instead of a blank notebook?

Starter question: Why is a quick floorplan and lighting sketch in Zone 1 just as important as sketching the artwork itself?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Set up the four inquiry zones on my A3 sheet: I rule and title the four field-recording boxes: 1. Sightline & Lighting map, 2. 5-Value tonal Thumbnail, 3. Surface close-up, 4. Critical notes.

Step 2: Draft three critical inquiry questions: I write three analytical questions focusing on how scale, surface patina, and raking light operate in the curated collection.

Step 3: Pilot-test Zone 2 on a preview work: I run a 4-minute pilot sketch in my preview box to confirm my graphite and fineliner kit captures five tonal values rapidly.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: Four inquiry zones set up, three questions selected, and pilot sketch completed.

Independent: Custom four-zone inquiry sheet, three analytical questions, and timed pilot study completed.

Aspire: Comparative dual-work inquiry protocol, curatorial rubric, and pilot thumbnail completed.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Provide stiff A3 clipboards and preview cards of the curated artwork collection so pupils can calibrate their 5-minute shorthand sketching style.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review how to scaffold gallery field-sketching templates and critical inquiry questions.